

FLEXBMS

System Overview

Home battery energy storage system

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System	96s LiFePO4 home BESS
Nominal capacity	314 Ah / approximately 96.5 kWh
Primary controller	STM32G491
Document status	Living architecture overview

This document explains the current FlexBMS system at architecture level. Schematics and source code remain authoritative for implementation details.

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1. System level

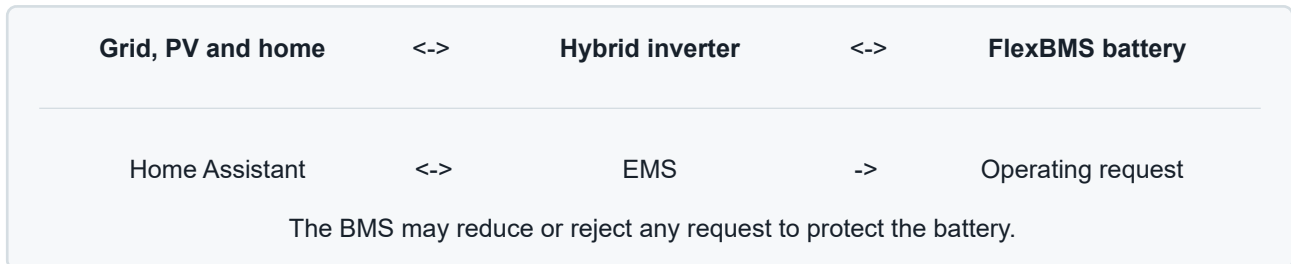
FlexBMS is the battery management and integration platform for a stationary home battery energy storage system. The battery consists of 96 LiFePO₄ cells in series, arranged as four 24-cell modules. At a nominal cell voltage of 3.2 V and a capacity of 314 Ah, the pack is approximately 307 V and 96.5 kWh.

The system connects the battery to a three-phase hybrid inverter. FlexBMS measures the battery, protects it, controls the high-voltage connection, and provides the information needed by higher-level energy management. The battery management system remains the final authority for battery safety.

1.1. System roles

Layer	Responsibility	Status
Battery and HV hardware	Stores energy, measures physical quantities, and safely connects the pack to the inverter.	CURRENT
STM32 BMS	Performs real-time measurement, protection, state handling, and contactor control.	CURRENT
ESP32 gateway	Provides local BMS maintenance, Wi-Fi provisioning, and telemetry transport while remaining listen-only on CAN.	CURRENT
Energy management system	Chooses when and how much to charge or discharge within BMS limits.	PLANNED
Home Assistant	Provides dashboards, automation, and a user-facing view of the installation.	CURRENT

1.2. Energy and information flow



Control principle

Energy management is advisory; battery protection is mandatory. The EMS may request an operating point, but the BMS defines the permitted charge and discharge envelope and can open the contactor.

2. Hardware

2.1. Battery assembly

The pack contains 96 series-connected LiFePO₄ cells divided into four physical 24s modules. Each module contains two twelve-cell monitoring sections. A 200 A / 75 mV shunt is located at the negative end of the pack for current measurement.

Item	Current baseline
Cell chemistry	LiFePO4
Series configuration	96s
Physical modules	4 x 24s
Cell capacity	314 Ah
Nominal pack voltage	307.2 V
Nominal stored energy	Approximately 96.5 kWh
Current shunt	200 A / 75 mV

The modules are installed in an unheated garage. Temperature measurement is distributed across the pack. The current STM32 configuration expects four NTC inputs per battery-monitor IC. Final sensor population and harness documentation should be kept consistent with the assembled modules.

2.2. Module boards

Each 24s module has one FlexBMS module board with two MC33771C battery cell controllers. Each controller measures twelve cells, supports passive balancing, reads local temperature sensors, and participates in the trans-former-isolated TPL daisy chain.

Across the complete pack this gives:

- eight MC33771C devices;
- 96 monitored cell voltages;
- up to 32 configured NTC measurements; and
- one current-sensing location on the first, lowest-voltage controller.

2.3. Master controller

The master board is the central interface between the battery, high-voltage switching hardware, service tools, inverter side, and local network.

Its main functional blocks are:

- STM32G491 real-time controller;
- MC33664 TPL transceiver for the module-board chain;
- ESP32-C3-WROOM-02U connectivity controller;
- isolated CAN and RS485 interfaces;
- isolated measurements of battery-side and load-side high voltage;
- contactor and precharge relay drivers;
- USB for flashing, diagnostics, and the Companion application; and
- power selection between USB and the battery-derived low-voltage supply.

The board contains separate HV, LV, and inverter-side isolated domains. USB-only power supports development and diagnostics, but does not provide the 12 V rail required to energize the contactor.

2.4. High-voltage path

The main contactor is located in the positive battery path. A separate precharge path limits inrush current before the contactor closes. The STM32 is the sole software owner of both drivers. It measures the battery and load sides through separate isolated AMC3330 channels, compares the battery-side result with the voltage reported by the cell-monitor chain, and observes both active-low diagnostic outputs.

The contactor is pulled in at full drive and then held with 20 kHz PWM. Precharge remains closed during pull-in and opens only after the contactor drive is established. The hold duty is a firmware configuration value.

Voltage feedback shows whether the two HV nodes are plausible and whether precharge has progressed. It does not prove the mechanical position of the contactor: the load-side voltage may remain present after opening because the inverter DC-link discharge behavior is not yet characterized.

Pack-level protection also includes the main DC fuse and a manual DC isolation device. Exact component ratings, wiring, creepage, clearance, and protection coordination belong in the hardware design files and commissioning documentation.

2.5. Physical communications

Interface	Connection	Purpose
TPL	Master to 8 monitor ICs	Cell, temperature, diagnostic, and current data.
USB	Service computer to STM32	Firmware, logs, and Companion access.
CAN	STM32 and inverter-side domain	Battery status and inverter communication.
Wi-Fi	ESP32 to local network	Local maintenance page, Wi-Fi provisioning, and future telemetry integration.
RS485	ESP32 to inverter-side equipment	Fallback or supplementary Modbus connection.

3. Software

The software is divided by responsibility. Time-critical protection and actuation remain on the STM32. Network-facing functions belong on the ESP32. Site optimization belongs in the EMS, with Home Assistant providing the local user and automation layer.

3.1. STM32

CURRENT

The STM32 firmware is the real-time BMS. It starts and monitors the MC33771C chain, gathers a complete battery measurement set, evaluates battery and communication faults, and controls relay permission.

The current battery profile is:

- eight MC33771C devices with twelve cells each;
- four NTC channels per controller on GPIO0 through GPIO3;
- current sensing on CID 1 with a 375 micro-ohm shunt value;
- positive current for charging and negative current for discharging;
- 314 Ah nominal capacity; and
- amp-hour retention in RTC backup registers while backup power is present.

The firmware separates active fault conditions and acknowledgement-required latches. The HV supervisor receives permission only while the BMS is running without blocking faults and holds one fresh, complete measurement set from the monitor chain.

Runtime faults keep measurement and monitoring active while preventing relay closure. An acknowledgement is accepted only after the underlying runtime condition has disappeared.

The STM32 also hosts:

- the dedicated HV supervisor;
- board-level analog and digital I/O;
- CAN communication;
- USB serial and the trusted text command/debug console; and
- the framed BMS v1 service interface over isolated UART and USB CDC.

3.1.1. Todo:

High priority:

- Go through CubeMX configuration. Pinout is OK.
- Analog measurement of HV side. Including diagnostic pin checking. ADC configuraion, high accuracy low Fs.
- Precharge handling. Including:
- Contactor handling. Including: economizing, failure checking using voltages (to be discussed)
- USB VSENSE setup
- Derating on temperature (mainly low temperature charging, high temperature is not that applicable)
- Communication to Goodwe inverter. Exact protocol needs discussion and likely imperial data once we have the inverter ready.
- User LED status language is specified in Documentation/architecture/home-bess-firmware-and-maintenance.md; firmware implementation remains pending.

Medium priority:

- Aux relay control (potentially useful for a future heating system).

3.2. HV supervisor

CURRENT

The HV supervisor follows OFF -> SELF_TEST -> PRECHARGE -> CONTACTOR_CLOSE -> RUN. The transport-independent `setRunRequest(bool)` operation is implemented through the framed BMS v1 named service. It provides intent only; it does not command a contactor. The STM32 accepts operation only when its BMS and HV-supervisor conditions are healthy.

SELF_TEST checks BMS permission, measurement freshness, isolated-voltage diagnostics, agreement between the battery-side and cell-monitor voltages, an unenergized load side, and the available power source. PRECHARGE raises the load-side voltage and requires a stable voltage relationship before contactor pull-in. CONTACTOR_CLOSE transfers from the precharge path to contactor hold drive. RUN keeps monitoring the BMS permission and both HV measurements.

A removed request, lost BMS permission, or implausible HV feedback disables both drivers. A blocking fault does not erase a true run request: after an explicit user acknowledgement and successful STM32 revalidation, the BMS may resume the startup sequence. The request defaults off after an STM32 reset; loss of a Gateway or USB Companion transport does not alter it. The STM32 reports requested state, actual HV state, and any blocking reason separately.

USB-only operation supports service access but cannot energize the HV path. A recorded run request still requires healthy BCC and HV validation before the STM32 can start. The fitted hardware pull-down defines the inactive USB-sense level; the STM32 does not enable an internal pull.

Source of truth

Thresholds, timings, fault definitions, CAN identifiers, and register-level behavior are intentionally not duplicated here. The STM32 source code and hardware schematics are authoritative.

3.3. ESP32

CURRENT

The ESP32 is the network and telemetry controller in the isolated inverter-side domain. Its intended role is to observe BMS and inverter information, publish selected data to the local network, and support integration with the EMS and Home Assistant.

The ESP32 is not part of the battery safety chain. It is not allowed to transmit commands on the BMS CAN bus and must remain listen-only there. Loss of the ESP32 or Wi-Fi must not prevent the STM32 from protecting or isolating the battery.

Software/Gateway implements isolated UART v1, Wi-Fi provisioning/station/recovery, and the local compiled Companion maintenance page. The Companion provides stale-status diagnostics, fresh BMS monitoring, CSV logging, register reads, Gateway NTP RTC synchronisation and device-time readback, fault clear, immediate run-request actions, and station-LAN firmware updates. MQTT Home Assistant discovery is a current Gateway function; CAN observation remains a separate planned increment. The Gateway uses isolated UART to the STM32 and remains listen-only on shared BMS/GoodWe CAN. It is not a safety authority. The detailed transport, local-network, and recovery design is in `Documentation/architecture/home-bess-firmware-and-maintenance.md`.

After a station reconnect, the Gateway withdraws and re-announces `flexbms.local`; a temporary mDNS failure is retried. Gateway OTA boots the inactive slot as pending and confirms it only after the local HTTP/WebSocket service starts and a station address returns. If that cannot happen within one minute, the ESP-IDF bootloader returns to the previous slot. Companion compares a content-derived web bundle identity and reloads its non-cacheable HTML shell automatically when a new bundle responds.

The local web service is intentionally bounded: it retains TCP capacity for MQTT and allows one queued telemetry frame per WebSocket. A browser that stops reading is retired after its first failed asynchronous send; a delayed callback from an old Companion socket cannot disturb its replacement connection.

The 4 MiB ESP32-C3 partition table uses two 1.5 MiB OTA application slots, a 512 KiB `bms_update` staging partition, and 384 KiB LittleFS reserved for future diagnostics/metadata. The committed Companion bundle is currently compiled into each application image, not served from LittleFS.

The Gateway application is written at the explicit `ota_0` offset in `Software/Gateway/partitions.csv` (currently `0x20000`), not ESP-IDF's generic `0x10000` default. Gateway release and normal PlatformIO upload tooling derive that address from the partition table; release creation verifies an ESP image magic byte at the derived address in the merged factory image.

3.3.1. Framed BMS protocol v1 contract

AGREED

The canonical byte-level implementation contract is `Documentation/protocol/uart-v1.md`. The following overview is retained in the system document; resolve any discrepancy in favour of the Markdown contract.

The STM32G491 BMS and ESP32-C3 Gateway communicate over isolated USART1 at 1 Mbit/s, 8-N-1, full duplex, without hardware flow control. Direct USB CDC uses the same framed bytes for the Web Serial Companion while retaining the trusted text command/debug console through a byte dispatcher. The STM32 is the safety authority. UART loss is a communication-health condition only: it must not force the HV path off or change the current run request. The `!` BMS Companion protocol is retired.

Each endpoint sends a zero-payload heartbeat every 500 ms. A peer is declared lost only after 1.5 s without a complete CRC-valid frame. Invalid bytes or frames with a bad CRC do not refresh the timer. The Gateway and direct USB Companion share one STM32 service slot; a second request receives `BUSY` rather than being queued.

All multi-byte values are little-endian. Encoders and decoders write and read individual fields; they must not transmit native C or C++ structs. The maximum payload length is 512 bytes.

3.3.1.1. Frame

offset	size	field
0	2	MAGIC = <code>0x46 0x42</code> ("FB")
2	1	VERSION = <code>0x01</code>
3	1	TYPE
4	1	SEQUENCE
5	2	LENGTH, uint16 payload length
7	n	PAYLOAD
7+n	4	CRC32, uint32

CRC is CRC-32/ISO-HDLC: polynomial `0x04C11DB7` (reflected `0xEDB88320`), reflected input and output, initial value and final xor `0xFFFFFFFF`. It covers the magic, header, and payload, but not the CRC field; the transmitted CRC word is little-endian. The standard check value is `CRC32("123456789") = 0xCBF43926`. On an invalid version, length, or CRC, the receiver discards the first magic byte and resumes magic scanning. The protocol uses no escaping or byte stuffing.

SEQUENCE = 0 is reserved for heartbeat, telemetry, and events. A Gateway or USB Companion service request uses a value from 1 through 255; the STM32 response echoes that sequence.

3.3.1.2. Types

ID	Type	Direction
0x01	HEARTBEAT	both
0x02	STATUS	STM32 to Gateway or USB Companion
0x03	PACK	STM32 to Gateway or USB Companion
0x04	CELL	STM32 to Gateway or USB Companion
0x05	TEMPERATURE	STM32 to Gateway or USB Companion
0x10	SERVICE_REQUEST	Gateway or USB Companion to STM32
0x11	SERVICE_RESPONSE	STM32 to Gateway or USB Companion
0x12	EVENT	STM32 to Gateway or USB Companion

3.3.1.3. Telemetry payloads

HEARTBEAT has an empty payload.

STATUS is 33 bytes:

```
bms_state:u8 | hv_state:u8 | flags:u16 | slave_count:u8 |
bms_active_errors:u32 | bms_latched_errors:u32 |
hv_active_errors:u32 | hv_latched_errors:u32 |
warnings:u32 | uptime_ms:u32 | soc_last_calibration_unix_s:u32
```

Status flag bits are: 0 BMS HV-ready, 1 charging allowed, 2 run request asserted, 3 complete measurements fresh, 4 isolated-UART Gateway peer alive, and 5 balancing request. USB Companion heartbeats do not affect bit 4. Bit 6 is SoC valid, bit 7 current sensing enabled, and bit 8 the SoC calibration UTC value valid; bits 9–15 are zero. `slave_count` comes from the configured BMS monitor chain and is variable between builds. A production module contains eight monitor slaves, but a single-slave development chain is supported during bench work. The Gateway must use the reported value and must not reject an odd count.

`uptime_ms` is the STM32 HAL millisecond tick since its most recent reset. It is diagnostic telemetry only, resets to zero after a controller restart, and wraps naturally after about 49.7 days. The STM32 sends STATUS at least every 500 ms while its UART service runs.

PACK is 24 bytes:

```
pack_voltage_uV:u32 | pack_current_raw:i16 | soc_raw:u16 |
min_cell_uV:u32 | max_cell_uV:u32 |
min_ntc_raw:u16 | max_ntc_raw:u16 | min_ic_raw:u16 | max_ic_raw:u16
```

Voltage values are microvolts. Current is signed amperes times 64; positive current is charging. SoC uses the existing BCC raw range (0 = -100%, 65535 = 200%), so percent is $100 * (\text{soc_raw} / 65535 * 3 - 1)$. The STM32 bounds its retained estimate and reported SoC to 0–100%, so the wider transport representation is not used in normal operation. NTC raw values convert as $\text{raw} / 65535 * 120 - 20$ degrees C. IC raw values are centikelvin, so degrees C are $\text{raw} / 100 - 273.15$.

Use `pack_current_raw` only when STATUS bit 7 is set and `soc_raw` only when bit 6 is set. SoC is informational and never commands HV. The estimate is retained in the CR2032-powered RTC backup domain with a version marker and checksum; an erased or corrupt value is invalid. Current sensing is deliberately disabled in the single-slave development configuration, so current and SoC are unavailable there. Production enables it only on CID 1. Full-charge calibration requires fresh measurements with no active BMS error, every cell at or above 3.450 V, current from -0.100 A through C/50 (6.28 A for the 314 Ah default), continuously for 300 s. Any failed condition restarts the timer; calibration sets SoC to 100%. Coulomb counting is bounded at 0% and 100%, allowing a subsequent discharge to lower SoC normally without retaining an out-of-range value. When valid UTC is available, the STM32 persists that instant in integrity-protected backup registers and reports it in `soc_last_calibration_unix_s`; it otherwise reports no calibration time.

CELL is 51 bytes, once per configured slave:

```
slave_index:u8 | balance_mask:u16 | cell_voltage_uV[12]:u32
```

`slave_index` is zero-based. `module_index = slave_index >> 1` and `slave_in_module = slave_index & 1`. Balance-mask bit 0 represents cell 0 through bit 11 for cell 11; bits 12–15 are zero. Each slave always has twelve cells. In a single-slave development chain, only index 0 is sent; it maps to module 0, slave 0, and no partner frame is implied.

TEMPERATURE is 11 bytes, once per configured slave:

```
slave_index:u8 | ntc_raw[4]:u16 | ic_temp_raw:u16
```

The four NTC values and one IC value are included together, making this packet fixed-size. This matches the installed four-NTC-per-slave configuration and must be enforced as a compile-time configuration check in both endpoint implementations.

The STM32 sends STATUS and a complete PACK/CELL/TEMPERATURE snapshot when fresh measurement data is available, no more often than once every 500 ms. It sends EVENT immediately on a change. The Gateway must treat PACK, CELL, and TEMPERATURE data as invalid while STATUS says measurements are not fresh.

3.3.1.4. States, faults, and events

BMS states are 0 STARTING, 1 READY, 2 RUNNING, 3 ERROR, and 4 CRITICAL. HV states are 0 OFF, 1 SELF_TEST, 2 PRECHARGE, 3 CONTACTOR_CLOSE, and 4 RUN. CRITICAL has no bitmap: it represents an unrecoverable condition in the current software and forces HV safe-off for the remainder of that boot.

BMS ERROR bitmap bits are: 0 CONFIGURATION_INVALID, 1 SLAVE_UNAVAILABLE, 2 BCC_DIAGNOSTICS, 3 CELL_VOLTAGE_LIMIT, 4 THERMAL_LIMIT, 5 CURRENT_LIMIT, 6 BCC_INTEGRITY, 7 ADC_FAULT, 8 BALANCING_HARDWARE_FAULT, and 9 BCC_COMMUNICATION. Bits 10–31 are reserved and zero.

HV ERROR bitmap bits are: 0 HV_SENSOR_DIAGNOSTIC, 1 BATTERY_VOLTAGE_MISMATCH, 2 LOAD_SIDE_ENERGISED, 3 PRECHARGE_TIMEOUT, 4 PRECHARGE_VOLTAGE_LOST, and 5 CONTACTOR_VOLTAGE_LOST. Bits 6–31 are reserved and zero.

warnings is non-latched. Bits are: 0 WATCHDOG_RESET, 1 STARTUP_DIAGNOSTICS_BYPASSED, and 2 BATTERY_VOLTAGE_MISMATCH_OFF. Bits 3–31 are reserved and zero. WATCHDOG_RESET is a recorded warning that an accepted acknowledgement clears. STARTUP_DIAGNOSTICS_BYPASSED remains present while that build configuration is active; BATTERY_VOLTAGE_MISMATCH_OFF remains present while the measurements disagree. WATCHDOG_RESET is set when this STM32 boot followed an independent or window watchdog reset. Gateway liveness, CAN condition, near-limit indication, and an inactive balancing request are not BMS warnings in this release.

The STM32 compares BAT+ and the slave-reported pack voltage continuously. A disagreement is an OFF-state warning while no run request is present; a run request promotes the same condition to the blocking BATTERY_VOLTAGE_MISMATCH HV error. Releasing the request deasserts that active HV error, retains its latch for acknowledgement, and restores the warning until the readings agree.

An active ERROR is present now. A latched ERROR remains blocking after its live condition clears until the STM32 accepts acknowledgement. The STM32 Fault Manager is the sole owner of active/latched aggregation, acknowledgement, and immediate HV safe-off. Detection modules may only assert or deassert their assigned condition. Startup monitor-chain, register-initialisation, and diagnostics attempts use their source retry budget before asserting their ERROR input. Once exhausted, they use these ordinary ERROR semantics.

A live TPL/BCC communication loss immediately safe-offs HV and re-enters the same non-blocking TPL, CID, register, and measurement initialisation path. A successful complete measurement and fault-status cycle deasserts the active communication error; its latched error still requires acknowledgement.

The independent watchdog starts after the required clock and DMA setup, before every fallible peripheral initialisation, has a nominal 500 ms timeout, and is refreshed every 100 ms only while both the PCC loop and BCC task continue to make progress. BCC initialisation retry waits are non-blocking, so they do not mask a stalled task. A subsequent platform-initialisation failure directly disables the precharge output and contactor PWM before the watchdog reset; the contactor driver pull-down is the hardware fallback. A clock-initialisation failure may occur before the watchdog is available; the hardware pull-down still holds the contactor control line safe.

The STM32 ADC is calibrated at startup. TIM7 triggers a three-rank HV scan at 50 Hz: load-side differential voltage, battery-side differential voltage, and VREFINT. Each rank uses 640.5 ADC clock cycles of acquisition and 256x oversampling with right-shift 4. DMA publishes complete scans as one snapshot. The STM32 drives VREF+ from its 2.9 V internal reference buffer. ADC/DMA errors and a 2.8–3.0 V ADC reference are checked every 20 ms. DMA progress is stale only after no completed scan for 100 ms. Three consecutive failed checks assert ADC_FAULT and immediately safe-off HV. Calibration is not repeated during normal operation.

EVENT is five bytes:

event_id:u8 | value:u32

ID	Event	Value
0x01	BMS state changed	new BMS state
0x02	HV state changed	new HV state
0x03	BMS active errors changed	new active mask
0x04	BMS latched errors changed	new latched mask
0x05	HV active errors changed	new active mask
0x06	HV latched errors changed	new latched mask
0x07	warnings changed	new warning mask
0x08	measurement freshness changed	0 or 1

EVENT is a convenience notification; STATUS is authoritative, so loss of an event is harmless.

3.3.1.5. Services

The service-request payload is service_id:u8 | arguments...; the service-response payload is service_id:u8 | result:u8 | response_data.... Result values are 0 OK, 1 DENIED, 2 INVALID, 3 BUSY, and 4 USB_HOST_ACTIVE. INVALID covers an unknown service, bad request length, bad argument, or nonexistent slave index. DENIED means a valid request cannot safely be performed in the current STM32 state. BUSY means another named service is still in progress. USB_HOST_ACTIVE means an enumerated USB host prevents the STM32 ROM bootloader from accepting USART1. OK means that the STM32 accepted and invoked the requested operation; STATUS and EVENT show the resulting operating state.

ID	Service	Request arguments	OK response data
0x01	GET_STATUS	none	33-byte STATUS
0x02	SET_RUN_REQUEST	requested:u8 (0 or 1)	none
0x03	ACKNOWLEDGE_FAULTS	none	none
0x04	READ_REGISTER	slave_index:u8, register:u8	slave_index:u8, register:u8, value:u16
0x05	SET_RTC	unix_time_s:u32 UTC	none
0x06	GET_DEVICE_INFO	none	firmware_version:u32
0x07	PREPARE_STM32_BOOTLOADER	firmware_version:u32, image_length:u32, image_crc32:u32	none
0x08	GET_RTC	none	unix_time_s:u32 UTC
0x09	SET_BALANCING_REQUEST	requested:u8 (0 or 1)	none
0x0A	COMMIT_STM32_BOOTLOADER	none	none (successful request enters ROM immediately)

SET_RUN_REQUEST(0) immediately removes the request through the STM32 PCC path. A request of 1 does not guarantee an HV start: the STM32 alone decides whether BMS and HV checks permit the sequence. ACKNOWLEDGE_FAULTS is denied while any ERROR condition remains active or the BMS is CRITICAL. It is also denied when no inactive BMS/HV ERROR latch or recorded WATCHDOG_RESET warning remains to clear. Accepted acknowledgement clears those states only, leaving live and configuration warnings visible until their underlying condition changes; it deliberately preserves the run request. PCC can therefore restart from OFF immediately once the Fault Manager permits it. Neither the Gateway nor Home Assistant can bypass a fault, write BCC registers, or override the HV supervisor. firmware_version is packed as major | (minor << 8) | (patch << 16) | (build << 24).

SET_BALANCING_REQUEST is an additional AND gate: a request of 1 does not guarantee balancing. The STM32 requires a running, fault-free BMS plus configured cell-voltage thresholds. A request of 0 disables the BCC balancing drivers on the next BCC loop. This development build defaults the volatile request to 0 after every reset; change and document that default explicitly for the production balancing enablement.

PREPARE_STM32_BOOTLOADER and COMMIT_STM32_BOOTLOADER form the STM32-update handoff. The Gateway must already have staged and CRC-checked the image. The STM32 validates the prepare request shape and image length; firmware_version and image_crc32 identify the Gateway-staged image but cannot be verified by an STM32 that does not receive its bytes. It returns DENIED unless the run request is off and it can de-energise the HV path. It returns USB_HOST_ACTIVE when its USB CDC device is enumerated. Prepare immediately holds HV safely off and blocks normal services, then returns OK. The prepared state expires after 3 seconds unless the Gateway sends commit. Commit has no response: after successfully transmitting it, the Gateway owns USART1 and immediately changes to ROM settings. If prepare or commit transmission fails, the STM32 remains in (or returns to) normal BMS operation; the Gateway reports failure rather than waiting indefinitely. It then performs ROM bootloader sync, transfer, readback verification, and Go directly on USART1; these are not FlexBMS UART messages. On return, the Gateway waits for an application heartbeat before reporting completion. Any failure after erase has begun requires wired STM32 recovery; the Gateway rejects further STM32 OTA attempts until it observes an application heartbeat. There are deliberately no update-data, retry, or status frame types.

3.3.1.6. Test vectors

The following complete frames are hexadecimal, including the little-endian CRC:

HEARTBEAT

46 42 01 01 00 00 00 8F 7A FB 7D

GET_STATUS, sequence 0x2A

46 42 01 10 2A 01 00 01 8F 21 B2 4B

SET_RUN_REQUEST(true), sequence 0x2B

46 42 01 10 2B 02 00 02 01 16 26 B1 DC

READ_REGISTER response, sequence 0x2C, slave 3, register 0x20, value 0x1234

46 42 01 11 2C 06 00 04 00 03 20 34 12 1A 45 F6 9C

PREPARE_STM32_BOOTLOADER, sequence 0x2D, version 1.2.3 build 4, image length 131072 bytes, image CRC32 0xA1B2C3D4

```
46 42 01 10 2D 0D 00 07 01 02 03 04 00 00 02 00 D4 C3 B2 A1 42 C9 9E 95
```

```
COMMIT_STM32_BOOTLOADER, sequence 0x2E
```

```
46 42 01 10 2E 01 00 0A 50 6F 02 53
```

3.3.2. Pinout

The Gateway uses an ESP32-C3-WROOM-02U-N4. The module pin names and numbers below follow the Espressif datasheet; net names follow the Master schematic. GPIO17 is used internally for module flash and is not exposed.

Module pin	GPIO / module name	Net	Use
1	3V3	p3v3_INV	3.3 V supply
2	EN	EN	Chip enable
3	GPIO4 / IO4	CAN_TX	CAN controller transmit
4	GPIO5 / IO5	CAN_RX	CAN controller receive
5	GPIO6 / IO6	RS485_R0	RS-485 receiver output
6	GPIO7 / IO7	RS485_DI	RS-485 driver input
7	GPIO8 / IO8	I08/STRAP	Strapping pin
8	GPIO9 / IO9	I09/B00T	Boot-mode strap
9; EPAD 19	GND	GND_INV	Ground and module ground pad
10	GPIO10 / IO10	ESP_VBUS_SENSE	USB VBUS sense
11	GPIO20 / RXD	–	Not connected; UART0 RX unused
12	GPIO21 / TXD	–	Not connected; UART0 TX unused
13	GPIO18 / IO18	USB_ESP32_N	USB D-
14	GPIO19 / IO19	USB_ESP32_P	USB D+
15	GPIO3 / IO3	UART_ESP_RX	STM32 USART1 TX input
16	GPIO2 / IO2	UART_ESP_TX	STM32 USART1 RX output; strapping pin
17	GPIO1 / IO1	USR_LED	Gateway user/status LED
18	GPIO0 / IO0	RS485_EN	RS-485 driver enable

3.4. Energy management system

PLANNED

The EMS is the supervisory optimization layer. It should combine battery availability with site demand, PV production, inverter limits, dynamic electricity prices, EV charging, and other flexible loads.

The EMS may request charging or discharging, but it must operate inside limits supplied by the BMS and inverter. It must tolerate missing telemetry and fall back to a safe, predictable operating policy.

The EMS implementation and deployment location are not yet defined in this repository. Its first interface should be a small, explicit contract containing battery state, available charge/discharge power, requested power, data freshness, and reason/status information.

3.5. Home Assistant integration

CURRENT

Home Assistant is the intended user-facing integration point for the installation. It can provide:

- battery, inverter, PV, grid, and load dashboards;
- fault and availability notifications;
- manual operating-mode selection;
- automation around dynamic prices and flexible loads; and
- long-term energy and temperature history.

Home Assistant must not become a safety dependency. If Home Assistant is unavailable, the STM32 must continue to protect the battery and the EMS must remain within the last valid limits or stop requesting power.

The Gateway publishes one retained MQTT Device Discovery record and retained compact BMS state below a MAC-derived `flexbms/flexbms_XXYYZZ` prefix. It exposes pack voltage/current/power, SoC when valid, cell and temperature extrema, BMS/HV state, active faults, freshness, UART health, and the STM32-owned run-request switch. Minimum and maximum cell voltage display in V with three decimals; cell delta displays as whole mV. It also exposes separate diagnostic uptime values for the ESP32 Gateway and STM32 BMS controller. ON and OFF requests share the existing single Gateway-to-STM32 service slot; the next STM32 status is authoritative and never promises contactor closure. Broker settings (host, port, username, write-only password) are configured only through the trusted station-LAN Companion page. The binary freshness, run-state, fault, and UART-health entities publish canonical MQTT ON/OFF states. Fault acknowledgement, balancing, firmware upload, registers, raw diagnostics, and inverter/EMS power control remain outside Home Assistant MQTT v1.

3.6. Companion application

CURRENT

Software/Companion is the FlexBMS-owned BMS-only application with two web targets: a direct USB Web Serial target for independent service diagnostics and an ESP32-hosted WebSocket target for local maintenance. A portable, unsigned Windows executable packages the direct-USB target in a thin Electron/Chromium wrapper. It has no installer, updater, or native serial-protocol implementation.

Both targets provide stale-status explanation, live fresh telemetry, CSV logging, named service requests, device-time readback, and read-only register inspection. The Gateway obtains UTC from NTP and shows its latest successful RTC sync in the browser locale; direct USB shows that NTP status is Gateway-only. The Gateway target also shows Wi-Fi and UART state and, only in connected station mode, single-bundle firmware updates. The direct-USB target exposes neither a raw terminal nor firmware-update UI; Gateway requests use an explicit allowlist.

`scripts/build-release.ps1` interactively confirms the release version, updates the Companion package version when a new one is entered, and builds the Companion, Gateway, and STM32 artifacts with checksums and one `FlexBMS_bundle.fbu` OTA package containing both targets, versions, byte lengths, and CRC-32 values. `-Version` supports unattended use. Each release includes `flash-release.ps1`: ST-Link/SWD flashes the STM32 image, while a selected ESP32-C3 COM port flashes a complete Gateway factory image. Both actions start immediately after checksum verification. Repeating an existing version requires an explicit choice and creates a timestamped output without overwriting the prior release.

4. Operating concept

4.1. Start-up

At start-up, the STM32 validates its configuration and initializes the complete TPL chain. It assigns each battery monitor a chain address, configures its registers, runs diagnostics, and obtains a fresh measurement set. Both HV outputs remain off. After BMS validation, the separate HV supervisor can run its self-test and precharge sequence only when a new run request is supplied.

4.2. Normal operation

During normal operation the STM32 repeatedly measures the pack and evaluates its safety state. Battery limits and status are made available to the surrounding system. The inverter converts energy between the DC battery and the AC installation, while the future EMS decides the desired operating point.

4.3. Faulted operation

A battery, measurement, or communication fault immediately removes relay permission. Monitoring continues where possible so that the live condition can be observed. Faults remain latched until they are acknowledged through the supported service path and the BMS has successfully revalidated the battery chain.

The BMS exposes the HV supervisor as one aggregate blocking fault while the supervisor retains separate active, latched, and historical HV reasons. The Companion clear command can clear an HV latch only when the live HV conditions are healthy. The BMS then repeats chain initialization, diagnostics, and a complete fault-checked measurement cycle before the latch is released. If the retained run request is true, the BMS may then resume its normal startup sequence. Historical reasons remain available until reboot.

Configuration and initial TPL setup faults require a reboot. The ESP32, EMS, and Home Assistant cannot override a blocking STM32 fault.

5. Interfaces and ownership

Information or action	Owner	Consumer
Cell voltages and temperatures	STM32 BMS	Diagnostics, inverter limits, telemetry
Battery current and SoC	STM32 BMS	Inverter, EMS, Home Assistant
Battery safety limits	STM32 BMS	Inverter and EMS
Contactor and precharge	STM32 BMS	Physical HV path
Inverter operating state	Inverter	ESP32 / EMS / Home Assistant
Requested charge/discharge power	EMS	Inverter-facing control interface
Dashboards and automation	Home Assistant	User and household services

The protocol between these layers should carry explicit validity and freshness information. A stale value must never be interpreted as a current permission to charge, discharge, or close the contactor.

6. Current project structure

Repository area	Contents
Hardware/Master	Master schematic, PCB, harnesses, and production data.
Hardware/ModuleBoard	Battery module-board schematic, PCB, and production data.
Software/Master	STM32G491 firmware and platform configuration.
Software/Companion	Current FlexBMS BMS maintenance UI with direct USB, Gateway, and portable Windows package outputs.
Software/Gateway	ESP32 UART v1, Wi-Fi provisioning/recovery, compiled Companion serving, Home Assistant MQTT discovery, and OTA; CAN observation remains planned.
Documentation/protocol/uart-v1.md	Canonical framed BMS protocol for Gateway UART and direct USB CDC, including test vectors.
Simulations	Electrical simulation files used during hardware development.
Documentation	This system overview and its Typst build setup.

The repository contains the initial ESP32 Gateway and FlexBMS Companion implementations. EMS and Home Assistant remain planned.

7. Open topics

This overview is intentionally incomplete. The next useful documentation additions are:

- confirmed as-built module, NTC, and high-voltage topology;
- final inverter selection, protocol compatibility, and commissioning sequence;
- system-level operating, fault, recovery, and shutdown policy;
- commissioning of the ESP32 telemetry, local-network, and update architecture; and

- EMS and Home Assistant interfaces, fallback behavior, and user permissions.